Infosys Verbal Ability – Advanced Practice

Detailed Grammar + Vocabulary + Difficult & Tricky Questions

New addition: Higher-difficulty sentence correction, error spotting, fill-in-the-blanks, vocabulary-in-context and grammar traps designed for serious practice.

SECTION A – Difficult Grammar & Sentence Correction

These questions focus on agreement traps, inversion, conditionals, subjunctive structures, modifiers, parallelism, tense sequence and advanced sentence correction.

1. Neither the quality of the products nor the after-sales services ___ satisfactory enough to justify the price.
   A) is B) are C) was D) has been
2. Had the committee ___ the proposal earlier, the project would not have been delayed.
   A) approved B) approves C) had approved D) approving
3. No sooner ___ the announcement made than the investors began reacting.
   A) had B) was C) has D) did
4. Scarcely had the train left the station ___ the alarm was raised.
   A) than B) when C) then D) while
5. The CEO insisted that every employee ___ the revised compliance policy.
   A) reads B) read C) reading D) has read
6. It is high time the management ___ action against repeated violations.
   A) takes B) took C) has taken D) will take
7. If he were more attentive, he ___ the error yesterday.
   A) would notice B) would have noticed C) will notice D) had noticed
8. The report, together with the supporting documents, ___ submitted before the deadline.
   A) were B) have been C) was D) are
9. One of the most important factors that ___ the outcome is the quality of data.
   A) determines B) determine C) determining D) have determined
10. The number of applicants who have cleared the first round ___ increased significantly.
    A) have B) are C) has D) were
11. The manager asked whether I ___ the issue before the client arrived.
    A) resolved B) had resolved C) have resolved D) resolve
12. He is one of those employees who always ___ their commitments.
    A) keeps B) keep C) keeping D) has kept
13. I would rather you ___ the matter confidential until the investigation is complete.
    A) keep B) kept C) will keep D) have kept
14. The candidate is not only intelligent but also ___ under pressure.
    A) works efficiently B) efficiently works C) efficient work D) efficiency
15. Having completed the assignment, the files ___ to the reviewer for verification.
    A) were sent B) sent C) had sending D) have send
16. The professor recommended that the student ___ the experiment before drawing a conclusion.
    A) repeats B) repeated C) repeat D) has repeated
17. Hardly had she reached the office when she realized that she ___ her laptop at home.
    A) leaves B) had left C) has left D) left
18. Not only ___ the deadline, but he also failed to notify the team.
    A) he missed B) did he miss C) he had missed D) had he miss
19. Were the company ___ the policy, several employees would lose access immediately.
    A) changes B) changed C) to change D) changing

20. The evidence suggests that neither the manager nor the analysts ___ aware of the discrepancy.
A) was B) were C) has been D) is

21. It was the repeated system failures that ___ the management to reconsider the architecture.
A) force B) has forced C) forced D) forcing

22. By the time the auditors arrive next Monday, the team ___ all the records.
A) will organize B) will have organized C) organized D) has organized

23. The consultant advised us to avoid ___ conclusions before all the data had been examined.
A) drawing B) to draw C) draw D) drew

24. Despite ___ repeatedly, the vendor failed to provide the required documents.
A) reminding B) being reminded C) reminded D) having remind

25. The project was completed in less time than ___ originally estimated.
A) was B) it was C) had been D) was it

SECTION B – Difficult Vocabulary in Context

26. Choose the closest meaning of Ubiquitous.

A) Rare B) Present everywhere C) Temporary D) Uncertain

27. Choose the antonym of Pragmatic.

A) Practical B) Realistic C) Idealistic D) Sensible

28. His explanation was so equivocal that nobody could determine his actual position. Equivocal means:

A) Clear B) Ambiguous C) Honest D) Detailed

29. Choose the closest meaning of Meticulous.

A) Careless B) Extremely careful C) Quick D) Flexible

30. Choose the antonym of Ephemeral.

A) Temporary B) Brief C) Permanent D) Short-lived

31. The manager's decision was arbitrary. This means the decision was:

A) Based on a consistent principle B) Random or based on personal choice C) Legally required D) Carefully documented

32. Choose the closest meaning of Inadvertent.

A) Intentional B) Accidental C) Immediate D) Repeated

33. The word ameliorate most nearly means:

A) Worsen B) Improve C) Delay D) Replace

34. Choose the antonym of Obfuscate.

A) Clarify B) Confuse C) Conceal D) Complicate

35. A cogent argument is one that is:

A) Weak B) Convincing and logically strong C) Emotional only D) Unrelated

36. Choose the closest meaning of Tenacious.

A) Persistent B) Fragile C) Indifferent D) Hesitant

37. The phrase read between the lines means:

A) Read quickly B) Find the hidden meaning C) Skip details D) Memorize text

38. A person who deliberately avoids work is a:

A) Philanthropist B) Procrastinator C) Optimist D) Linguist

39. Choose the word that best completes the sentence: 'The witness gave a ___ account, leaving no room for doubt.'

A) lucid B) obscure C) tenuous D) dubious

40. Choose the best word: 'The evidence was too ___ to support such a serious allegation.'

A) compelling B) conclusive C) tenuous D) definitive

SECTION C – Advanced Answer Key with Explanations

Q	Ans.	Explanation
1	B	With neither...nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject: services → are.
2	A	Third conditional inversion: Had + subject + V3. 'Had the committee approved...'
3	B	Fixed structure: No sooner had...than. Here the passive structure is 'was the announcement made'.
4	B	Fixed pair: scarcely/hardly/barely...when.
5	B	After 'insisted that' in formal subjunctive usage, use the base verb: read.
6	B	It is high time + past tense: 'It is high time management took action.'
7	B	Mixed conditional: unreal present condition + unreal past result → would have noticed.
8	C	Main subject is singular 'report'; together with does not change it.
9	B	'Factors' is plural and is the subject of 'determine'.
10	C	The number of + singular verb → has.
11	B	The resolving happened before another past event → past perfect.
12	B	'Those employees' is plural → keep.
13	B	Would rather + subject + past tense for present/future preference.
14	A	Parallel structure: not only intelligent but also works efficiently.
15	A	The files receive the action → passive: were sent.
16	C	Recommend that + base verb is standard formal subjunctive usage.
17	B	Leaving the laptop happened before realizing it → had left.
18	B	Negative/limiting expression at the beginning causes inversion: did he miss.
19	C	Formal conditional inversion: Were the company to change...
20	B	Nearer subject is analysts → were.
21	C	Subject is 'system failures' but relative clause structure and completed past event require forced.
22	B	By a future deadline → future perfect: will have organized.
23	A	Avoid + gerund.
24	B	The vendor was reminded → passive gerund: being reminded.
25	C	Comparison with an earlier estimate: than had been originally estimated.
26	B	Ubiquitous = present or found everywhere.
27	C	Pragmatic = practical; antonym = idealistic.
28	B	Equivocal = open to more than one interpretation; ambiguous.
29	B	Meticulous = very careful and precise.
30	C	Ephemeral = short-lived; antonym = permanent.
31	B	Arbitrary = based on random/personal choice rather than consistent reasoning.
32	B	Inadvertent = accidental/unintentional.
33	B	Ameliorate = improve or make better.
34	A	Obfuscate = make unclear; antonym = clarify.
35	B	Cogent = clear, logical and convincing.
36	A	Tenacious = persistent/determined.
37	B	Read between the lines = infer an unstated meaning.

Q	Ans.	Explanation
38	B	Procrastinator = one who delays or puts off tasks.
39	A	Lucid = clear and easy to understand.
40	C	Tenuous = weak or insufficiently supported.

Advanced exam tip: For difficult grammar questions, first identify the core subject and main verb. Then check whether an introductory phrase, relative clause, parenthetical phrase, inversion, or conjunction is hiding the actual grammatical structure. For vocabulary, use context clues before relying on direct memorization.